

Justin Smidt

DevOps & Cloud Engineer

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PROFILE

DevOps and Cloud Engineer with hands-on experience building a cloud platform from the ground up on Azure AKS — networking, managed data stores, CI/CD, and production operations — alongside experience maintaining production workloads on AWS EKS. Backed by a software engineering foundation, I approach infrastructure with an emphasis on automation, version control, and systems that stay reliable under pressure.

EXPERIENCE

DevOps & Cloud Engineer

Feb 2025 – Present

S-Squared Software Development · *Client: Blulabel Telecoms*

Unipay Azure AKS

- Sole infrastructure engineer responsible for building dev, QA, and production environments entirely from scratch on Azure AKS using Terraform.
- Designed and provisioned VNets, subnets, and NSGs to establish the underlying network foundation for each AKS environment.
- Set up multiple managed databases with private endpoint access enforced via jumpbox.
- Deployed and configured Redis (caching) and RabbitMQ (message brokering) as supporting platform services.
- Implemented Nginx ingress controller, provisioned DNS A-records, and authored ingress manifests for all workloads across all three environments.
- Built and maintained CI/CD pipelines and Helm charts for approximately 20 microservices deployed across the platform.

Ticketpro AWS EKS

- Maintained the production Kubernetes environment on AWS EKS, covering cluster health, workload deployments, and incident response.

Additional Blulabel Projects AWS · Azure · On-Premises

- Contribute across a broader portfolio of Blulabel projects spanning AWS, Azure, and on-premises environments, with all repositories and pipelines hosted on Azure DevOps.
- Maintain and troubleshoot existing CI/CD pipelines across these environments, diagnosing and resolving build and deployment issues on infrastructure originally provisioned by other teams.

Junior Software Developer

Mar 2024 – Feb 2025

S-Squared Software Development

- Placed on the Interface project, a bespoke solution developed for Alexander Forbes, working alongside a senior developer.
- Developed backend services and REST APIs in Java and contributed to the AngularJS frontend.
- Participated in code reviews, sprint planning, and feature delivery across the full development cycle.

Intern Software Developer

Nov 2023 – Mar 2024

S-Squared Software Development

- Performed manual and functional testing on the BluAdvance project.
- Documented bugs, tracked issues, and collaborated with developers to verify fixes.
- Gained hands-on exposure to the software development lifecycle in a professional environment.

Marketing Graduate Program

2019

MacDonald's Transport, Kwazulu-Natal

- Rotated across Sales & Marketing, Logistics, and Operations departments to gain exposure to the full organization.
- Conducted customer site visits to understand customer-specific requirements and appropriate solutions.
- Oversaw port activities for incoming vessels and supported warehouse layout and stock management.
- Coordinated yard activities for receiving and storing goods.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computing (Honours) — NQF Level 8

2020 – 2023

Belgium Campus ITversity

Magna Cum Laude

Bachelor of Commerce: Marketing Management

2015 – 2018

North-West University

SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure

AWS Azure EKS AKS VNets Subnets DNS

CI/CD & Automation

CI/CD Pipelines Nginx Redis RabbitMQ Bash

IaC & Orchestration

Terraform Kubernetes Helm Docker

Development

Java AngularJS TypeScript SQL